

Visibility



Image Source:
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- This is a control panel for an elevator
- How does it work?
- Push a button for the floor you want?
- Nothing happens. Push any other button?
Still nothing. What do you need to do?
- It is not visible as to what to do!

Visibility

...you need to insert your room card in the slot by the buttons to get the elevator to work!



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How would you make this action more visible?

- make the card reader more obvious
- provide an auditory message, that says what to do (which language?)
- provide a big label next to the card reader that flashes when someone enters
- make relevant parts visible
- make what has to be done obvious

What do I do if I am wearing black?

Invisible automatic controls can make it more difficult to use

Figure 1.10 A sign in the restrooms at Cincinnati airport. Because it is not visible to the user as to what to do to turn the faucet (tap) on and off, a sign has been added to explain what is normally an everyday and well-learned activity. It does not explain, however, what to do if you are wearing black clothing

